

JesusOnline Equip

Ministry Resources Hub

The World vs. the Word

A free resource from JesusOnline Ministries.

Read or share online: app.jesonline.com/post/22820-011-the-world-vs-the-word

JesusOnline Equip · Ministry Resources Hub · equip.jesonline.com

Free media and discipleship resources for pastors, leaders, and growing disciples.

The World vs. the Word

“For the word of God is alive and powerful. It is sharper than the sharpest two-edged sword, cutting between soul and spirit, between joint and marrow. It exposes our innermost thoughts and desires.” (Hebrews 4:12, NLT)

We can't grow in our relationship with God, through the Son, or experience the Holy Spirit, without the Word of God. In order for our lives to echo into eternity we need to embrace what the Bible tells us about who God is and how he works. Our entire being is wrapped up in Christ Jesus and what he did for us on the cross. Our desire for the Holy Spirit comes from Jesus and is fueled by Jesus, and we learn about all of this from God's Word.

Just as it is impossible to grow physically without physical food, it is impossible to grow spiritually without the food of the Word of God. When you plant God's Word in your heart it will accomplish everything that God wants to develop and grow in you. It will actually prosper in your heart. How do I know this? Because God's Word promises it! *“It is the same with my word. I send it out, and it always produces fruit. It will accomplish all I want it to, and it will prosper everywhere I send it” (Isaiah 55:11, NLT).*

I love to play with words. During my devotional time one day, I placed two words side by side: **WORLD** **WORD**

It occurred to me that each of these words is promoting a message. The *world* wants us to embrace its message of “Me, Myself, and I.” This message is in direct opposition to what God's *Word* has to say to us. God's Word is a story of sacrifice and giving. We must make a choice as to which message we are going to listen to and obey.

As I sat looking at those two words, I realized that if you drop the “I” out of *world* you have *word*. I thought to myself, *The “I” stands for what I am living for in this life. I need to take that “I” of the world and move it under the Word, bringing what I am living for in this world into submission to the Word of God.*

In the Old Testament we read, “Those who worship false gods turn their backs on all God's mercies” (Jonah 2:8, NLT). The world has a lot of “false gods” to offer. If you Google the term “false gods,” Wikipedia actually says they are “other competing

entities or objects to which particular importance is attributed.” There are many things in this world that have the power to turn our hearts away from God. False gods include money, possessions, success, school, careers, friends, and even family. Tim Keller, in *Counterfeit Gods*, defines a false god this way: “Anything more important to you than God, anything that absorbs your heart and imagination more than God, anything you seek to give you what only God can give.”

And so, each one of us has a choice to make each day. Are we going to follow the pathway of the world or walk in the way God’s Word directs us? Are we going to allow false gods to steal our allegiance or are we going to stay true to the God of the Bible? Are we going to take our directions from the world manual or the Word manual? What is our true desire?

In what ways are you letting the world guide your life? In what ways is God’s Word giving you direction?

Son Power is grounded in God’s Word.